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Graduate Recruitment Team

Fidelity International

4 Cannon Street

London EC4M 5AB

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Equity Research Graduate Programme 2027 in London, with a particular interest in energy and materials coverage. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Fidelity's research model, in which its analysts hold more than 20,000 company meetings a year, is the kind of primary research I want to learn to do.

Equity research rewards a view that is stated plainly and tested honestly, and that is how I try to work. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, asks whether news improves forecasts of European gas volatility: I am building mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models from daily storage, market and news-based data, testing them out-of-sample against established benchmarks and asking whether better forecasts carry economic value. I also tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries, finding that momentum and value alphas survive statistical scrutiny far more often than size, and my final-year modules include Industrial Economics and Natural Resource, Environmental and Energy Economics, which give me a framework for how industries compete.

What draws me to research is the writing as much as the analysis: a note is only useful if a busy reader can act on it. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I published weekly research notes and dashboards and led sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining each to members from outside finance.

Fidelity International's research platform stands out to me because its analysts speak to a company's management roughly every ten minutes of every working day, and because it publishes their collective view in its annual Analyst Survey, whose 2026 edition covers energy prices, rare earth metals and the effect of geopolitics on company earnings. Those are the themes I study through European gas markets, and I would like to learn how Fidelity's analysts turn company meetings into a view a portfolio manager can act on.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan